

# From empty repo to development-ready

The initiation workflow, one step at a time. Each step is one Claude command, run in its own fresh session **from the kit**. It produces one document in your **target repo**, and that document is final only when you merge its PR/MR to `main`.

- Kit · Claude session (control plane)
- Target repo clone
- You (approve, review, merge)
- Git host · PR/MR

## Two repos, one operator

You run every command from the kit. The kit's guides, runner and templates never get copied into your project; only the documents you produce land there.

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><a href="#">KIT · run commands here</a></p> <p><b>Control plane</b></p> <p>Commands, step guides, templates, step registry, role files.</p> <p><code>.claude/commands/proj-init-*</code><br/><code>docs/guides/proj-init/</code><br/><code>.proj-init/state.json</code></p> | <p><a href="#">TARGET · registered by Step-00</a></p> <p><b>Your project clone</b></p> <p>Every git operation and every produced document lands here.</p> <p><code>CONTRIBUTING.md</code> · <code>README.md</code><br/><code>docs/PRODUCT.md</code> ...<br/><code>docs/BACKLOG.md</code><br/>AI tool adapters</p> | <p>GIT HOST · GitHub, Azure DevOps, GitLab, Bitbucket</p> <p><b>Review and merge</b></p> <p>One branch and one PR/MR per step. Merge to <code>main</code> = final.</p> <p><code>init/&lt;step&gt;</code> → PR/MR → <code>main</code><br/><code>gh</code> · <code>az repos</code> · <code>glab</code> · web UI</p> |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## Where a document sits

No draft files and no status flags. A doc on a branch is a draft; a doc on `main` is final.

|                                                                               |                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>Not started</b></p> <p>Not on <code>main</code>, no branch</p> <p>–</p> | <p><b>Draft</b></p> <p>On <code>init/&lt;step&gt;</code> in the target</p> <p><code>/proj-init-&lt;step&gt;</code></p> | <p><b>In review</b> · you</p> <p>Pushed after your yes, PR/MR open</p> <p><code>gh pr create</code> · <code>az repos pr create</code> · <code>glab mr create</code></p> | <p><b>Final</b> · you</p> <p>Merged after the self-review checklist</p> <p><code>merge to main</code></p> |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

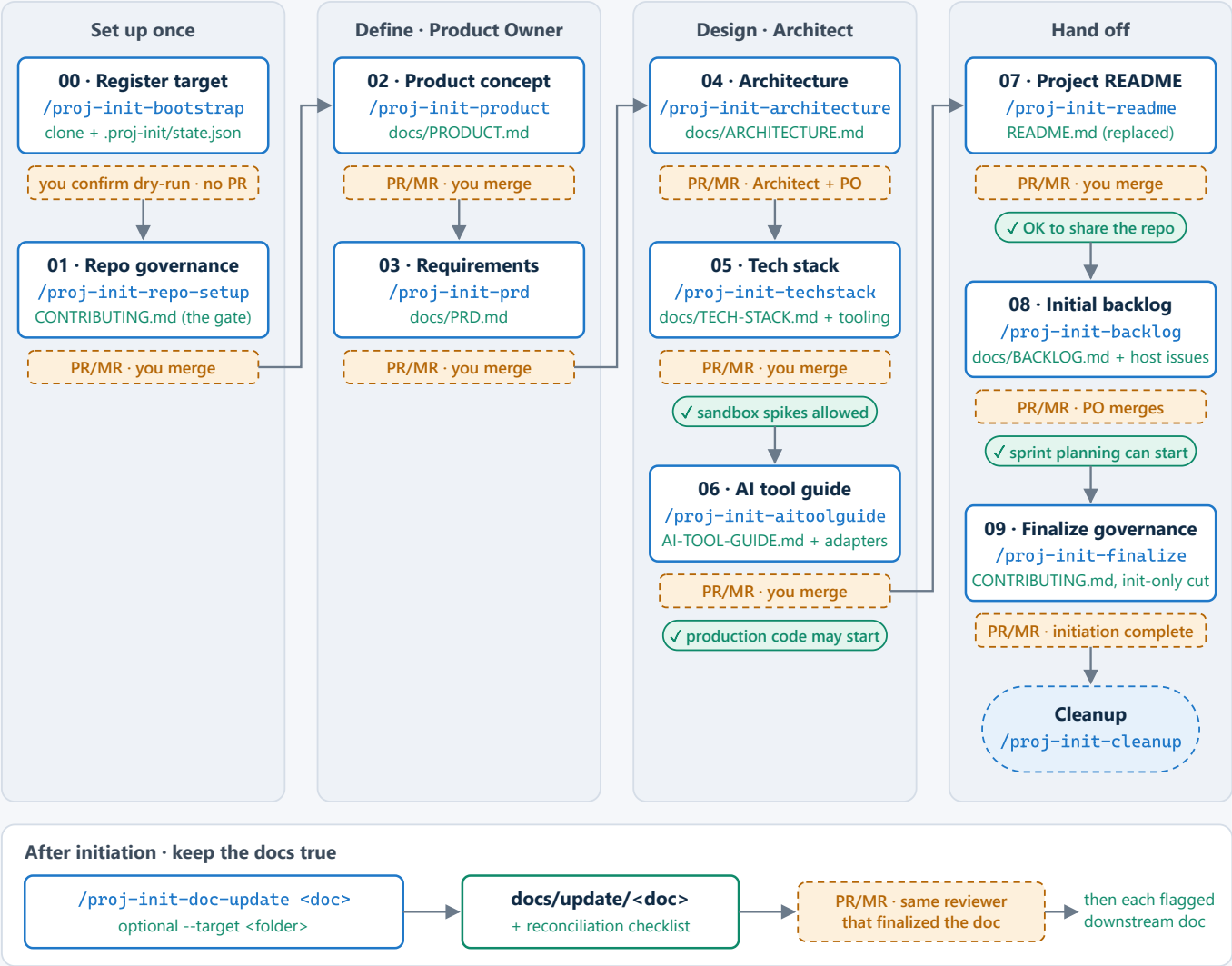
## Start every step the same way

|          |                                                                                             |
|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| TERMINAL | <pre># from the kit folder – never from the target clone cd &lt;kit-folder&gt; claude</pre> |
| CLAUDE   | <pre>/proj-init-&lt;step&gt;           # e.g. /proj-init-product</pre>                      |

**One step, one session.** For the next step, run `/clear` or start a new `claude` session. Steps 02–09 run the status check themselves; run `/proj-init-doc-status` any time to see what's merged, what's open, and what's next. GitHub Copilot Chat users run the same `/proj-init-*` names from `.github/prompts/`.

# The whole flow

Two one-time setup steps, then one document per step. Every step from 01 to 09 ends in a PR/MR that you merge. A step won't start until the documents it depends on are on `main`.



## What each step waits for

The runner checks these on the target's `main` before it creates a branch. If any is missing, it stops and names it.

| Step | Needs on main                  | Step    | Needs on main                                             |
|------|--------------------------------|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| 01   | Step-00 registration only      | 06      | ARCHITECTURE.md , TECH-STACK.md                           |
| 02   | CONTRIBUTING.md (Step-01 gate) | 07      | PRODUCT , PRD , ARCHITECTURE , TECH-STACK , AI-TOOL-GUIDE |
| 03   | PRODUCT.md                     | 08      | all of 07's inputs + README.md                            |
| 04   | PRD.md                         | 09      | BACKLOG.md                                                |
| 05   | PRD.md , ARCHITECTURE.md       | Cleanup | BACKLOG.md , init-only block gone from CONTRIBUTING.md    |

# Step by step

Run every command from the kit folder, one per fresh session. Steps 02–09 share one runner: resolve the target, check status and preconditions, wait for your **yes**, branch, interview you one question at a time, draft, commit, then push and open the PR/MR only after a second **yes**.

00

Register the target repo

Kit

You confirm

Clones your project repo and records where it lives, so every later step operates on that clone. Nothing is committed or pushed.

CLAUDE

/proj-init-bootstrap

ASKS

The target's git URL, and an empty or non-existent local folder to clone into.

RUNS

`node scripts/bootstrap-target-repo.mjs --target <folder> --url <git-url>` as a dry run, then again with `--apply`

WRITES

The clone at `<folder>` , plus `.proj-init/state.json` in the kit (gitignored, local to this machine)

GATE

■ You review the dry run before `--apply` . Only one workspace at a time; replace it only with `--force` .

GIT

No branch, no commit, no PR/MR.

01

Set up repo governance

Kit

Target

You merge

The gate every later step relies on: the branching convention, the commit convention, and the self-review checklist.

CLAUDE

/proj-init-repo-setup

OWNER

Architect · reviewed by Architect

WRITES

`CONTRIBUTING.md` : permanent rules plus an `INITIATION-ONLY` fenced block, and branch protection on `main` if your host and plan allow it

GIT

`init/repo-setup` · docs: add repo governance baseline (Step-01)

GATE

■ Self-review checklist, then you merge. Every later step stops until `CONTRIBUTING.md` is on `main` .

02

Product concept

Kit

Target

You merge

What we are building, and why.

CLAUDE

/proj-init-product

OWNER

Product Owner · reviewed by Product Owner

READS

`CONTRIBUTING.md` on `main` (the Step-01 gate)

WRITES

`docs/PRODUCT.md`

GIT

`init/product` · docs: add `PRODUCT.md` (Step-02)

GATE

■ The Product Owner approves and merges.

03

## Product requirements

● Kit

● Target

● You merge

Turns the concept into testable requirements.

CLAUDE

/proj-init-prd

**OWNER** Product Owner · reviewed by Product Owner

**READS** docs/PRODUCT.md

**WRITES** docs/PRD.md

**GIT** init/prd · docs: add PRD.md (Step-03)

**GATE** ■ The Product Owner approves and merges.

04

## Architecture

● Kit

● Target

● You merge

System structure and design decisions. The runner loads both the Architect and Product Owner role context.

CLAUDE

/proj-init-architecture

**OWNER** Architect · reviewed by Architect + Product Owner

**READS** docs/PRD.md

**WRITES** docs/ARCHITECTURE.md

**GIT** init/architecture · docs: add ARCHITECTURE.md (Step-04)

**GATE** ■ The Architect and Product Owner both approve, then merge.

05

## Tech stack

● Kit

● Target

● You merge

Locks the approved technologies and adds the build/test/lint commands to CONTRIBUTING.md .

CLAUDE

/proj-init-techstack

**OWNER** Architect · reviewed by Architect

**READS** docs/PRD.md , docs/ARCHITECTURE.md

**WRITES** docs/TECH-STACK.md ; appends the tooling layer to CONTRIBUTING.md and leaves the Step-01 governance layer intact

**GIT** init/techstack · docs: add TECH-STACK.md and CONTRIBUTING tooling layer (Step-05)

**GATE** ■ The Architect approves and merges.

**AFTER MERGE** Sandbox spikes are allowed, on isolated spike branches that never merge to main .

06

## AI tool guide

● Kit

● Target

● You merge

The rules every AI tool follows on this project. Shared rules live in one guide; each adapter carries only what's specific to its tool.

CLAUDE

/proj-init-aitoolguide

OWNER

Architect · reviewed by Architect

ASKS

Which AI tools the team will use. This is asked before any adapter is generated.

READS

docs/ARCHITECTURE.md , docs/TECH-STACK.md

WRITES

docs/AI-TOOL-GUIDE.md every time, plus adapters only for the tools you picked, e.g. CLAUDE.md or .github/copilot-instructions.md

GIT

init/aitoolguide · docs: add AI-TOOL-GUIDE.md and tool adapters (Step-06)

GATE

■ The Architect approves and merges.

AFTER MERGE

Production implementation can start.

07

## Project README

● Kit

● Target

● You merge

Replaces the target's boilerplate README with a real entry point: setup, environment config, and how to run.

CLAUDE

/proj-init-readme

OWNER

Architect · reviewed by Architect

READS

PRODUCT.md , PRD.md , ARCHITECTURE.md , TECH-STACK.md , AI-TOOL-GUIDE.md

WRITES

README.md , replacing the existing file with all placeholders removed

GIT

init/readme · docs: replace boilerplate README with project README (Step-07)

GATE

■ Every command in the README is tested before commit. The Architect approves and merges.

AFTER MERGE

Required before the repo is shared more widely.

08

## Initial backlog

● Kit

● Target

● Host

● You merge

Epics and stories derived from the product and requirements docs, seeded into your issue tracker.

CLAUDE

/proj-init-backlog

OWNER

Product Owner · reviewed by Product Owner

READS

The five docs Step-07 reads, plus README.md

WRITES

docs/BACKLOG.md , plus host work items via gh or az boards ; with neither CLI available, PENDING IDs and manual creation notes

GIT

init/backlog · docs: add BACKLOG.md – Step-08 initial backlog

GATE

■ You approve the derived backlog before anything is written to the host or to disk. Items are then created one at a time. The Product Owner merges.

AFTER MERGE

Required before sprint planning. Next: Step-09.

09

## Finalize governance

● Kit

● Target

● You merge

Removes the initiation-only rules from `CONTRIBUTING.md` and hands the team a permanent contribution core.

CLAUDE

/proj-init-finalize

OWNER

Architect · reviewed by Architect

READS

`docs/BACKLOG.md` on `main` (the gate) and `CONTRIBUTING.md` on `main`

WRITES

`CONTRIBUTING.md`: the `INITIATION-ONLY` block is removed (markers included) and a `DEVELOPMENT-PHASE-GOVERNANCE` stub is inserted. Permanent rules and the tooling layer stay verbatim.

GIT

`init/finalize` · `docs: finalize CONTRIBUTING.md for the development phase (Step-09)`

GATE

■ Stops if the `INITIATION-ONLY` markers are missing. Once the Architect merges, initiation is complete.

✓

## Clean up the workspace

● Kit

● You confirm

Unregisters the workspace from the kit. The target clone and its remote are left untouched.

CLAUDE

/proj-init-cleanup

CHECKS

`docs/BACKLOG.md` is on `main` and `INITIATION-ONLY` is gone from `CONTRIBUTING.md`

RUNS

`node scripts/bootstrap-target-repo.mjs --clear`, after your **yes**

WRITES

Deletes `.proj-init/state.json`. Nothing else.

GIT

None.

## Utilities, any time

CLAUDE

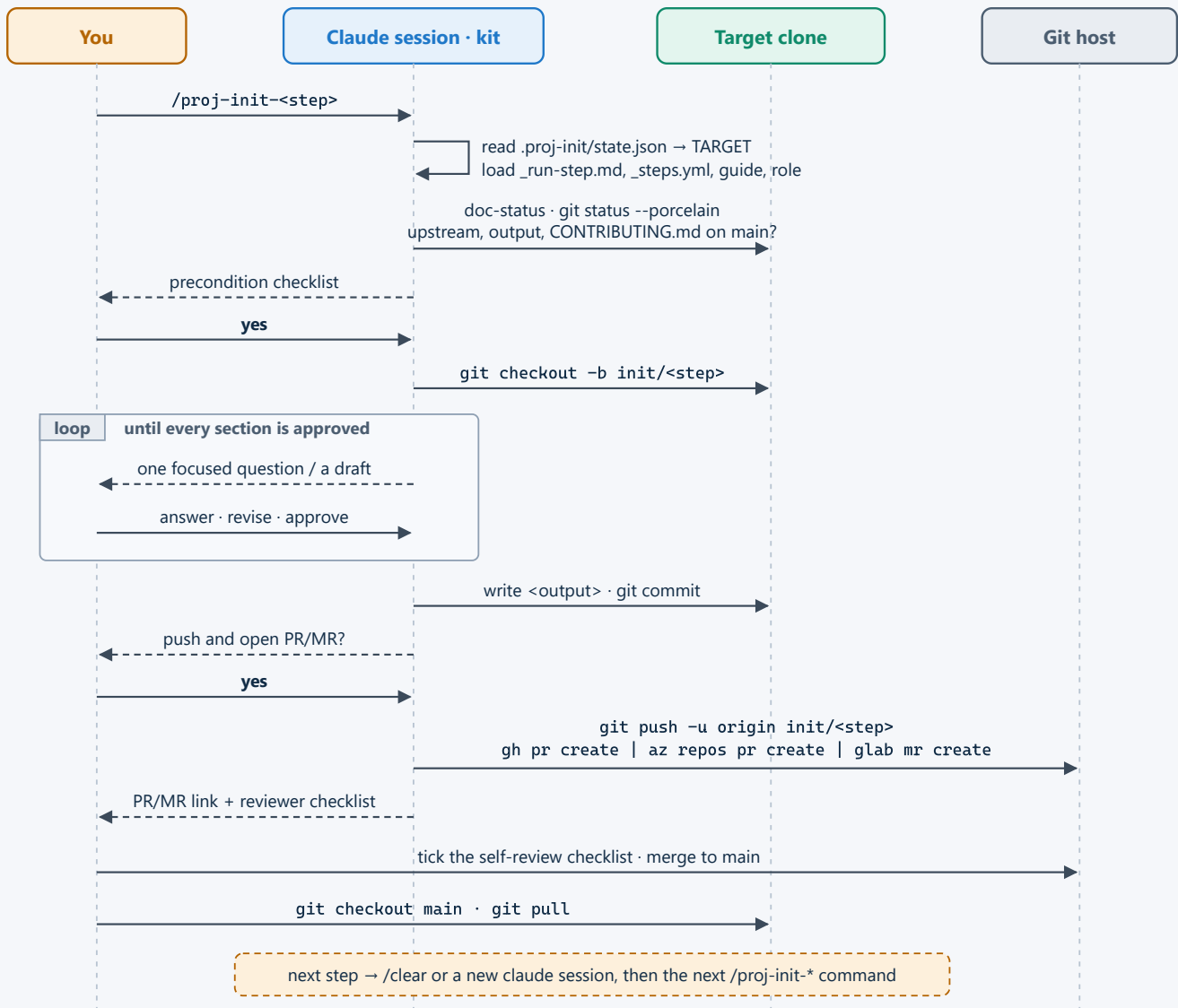
```
/proj-init-doc-status           # read-only: merged, open PRs/MRs, what's next
/proj-init-doc-update <doc>    # e.g. PRD.md → PR/MR + reconciliation checklist
# add --target <folder> to either for a finished or other project
```

## Which document to update

| If this happens                                                    | Run <code>/proj-init-doc-update</code> on |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Product scope, goal, or target users change                        | <code>PRODUCT.md</code>                   |
| Requirements or acceptance criteria change                         | <code>PRD.md</code>                       |
| System design or a major architecture decision changes             | <code>ARCHITECTURE.md</code>              |
| A library, framework, or tool is added, removed, or version-locked | <code>TECH-STACK.md</code>                |
| AI tool rules, banned patterns, or scope boundaries change         | <code>AI-TOOL-GUIDE.md</code>             |
| Setup steps, env config, or run commands change                    | <code>README.md</code>                    |
| Epics or stories added, removed, rescoped, or host IDs change      | <code>BACKLOG.md</code>                   |

## One step up close

What happens between you, the Claude session in the kit, the target clone, and your Git host during any step from 02 to 09.



## After the PR/MR opens

From here on it's your job. The command's job ended when the PR/MR opened.

1. **Give it fresh eyes.** Wait at least a few hours, ideally a full day, before reviewing.
2. **Tick the self-review checklist** in the PR/MR description: every required section is covered, no upstream doc changed after you branched, and the change went through a PR/MR, not a direct push.
3. **Merge to main**. Merging is what makes it final. Step-04 also needs the Product Owner's sign-off.
4. **Refresh main in the target**, so the next step's precondition check sees the merged doc:

### TERMINAL

```
git -C <target-folder> checkout main
git -C <target-folder> pull --ff-only
```

5. **Start the next step in a fresh session.**

## Rules that hold at every step

|                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>One step, one fresh session.</b><br>Never run two step commands in the same session. Status is checked first, then only the step you asked for runs.      | <b>Run from the kit, write to the target.</b><br>Commands load guides from the kit and do git work in the registered clone. Kit files are never copied in.                           |
| <b>Merge = final.</b><br>A doc on a branch is a draft; a doc on <code>main</code> is final. There are no draft files and no status flags.                    | <b>Nothing ships without your yes.</b><br>Explicit confirmation before branching, before every host write, and before every push.                                                    |
| <b>Never on <code>main</code>.</b><br>No commits or pushes to <code>main</code> , and no force-pushes to shared branches. Every change goes through a PR/MR. | <b>Upstream first.</b><br>A step stops if any doc it depends on isn't on <code>main</code> , or if its own output is already final (use <code>/proj-init-doc-update</code> instead). |
| <b>Same machine, same operator.</b><br><code>.proj-init/state.json</code> is local to one machine. To continue elsewhere, re-run Step-00.                    | <b>Never assume an answer.</b><br>Claude asks one focused question at a time until no template placeholder is left.                                                                  |

## Milestones

|                                                                                                              |                                                                                    |                                                                                        |                                                                                        |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>AFTER 05 MERGES</b><br><b>Spikes</b><br>Isolated spike branches only, never merged to <code>main</code> . | <b>AFTER 06 MERGES</b><br><b>Production code</b><br>Implementation work can begin. | <b>AFTER 07 MERGES</b><br><b>Share the repo</b><br>The README is the real entry point. | <b>AFTER 08 MERGES</b><br><b>Sprint planning</b><br>Then Step-09 completes initiation. |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## Command cheat sheet

| Step | Claude command                       | Produces in the target                               | Merged by       |
|------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| 00   | <code>/proj-init-bootstrap</code>    | clone + kit-local <code>.proj-init/state.json</code> | — (you confirm) |
| 01   | <code>/proj-init-repo-setup</code>   | <code>CONTRIBUTING.md</code> (governance)            | Architect       |
| 02   | <code>/proj-init-product</code>      | <code>docs/PRODUCT.md</code>                         | Product Owner   |
| 03   | <code>/proj-init-prd</code>          | <code>docs/PRD.md</code>                             | Product Owner   |
| 04   | <code>/proj-init-architecture</code> | <code>docs/ARCHITECTURE.md</code>                    | Architect + PO  |
| 05   | <code>/proj-init-techstack</code>    | <code>docs/TECH-STACK.md</code> + tooling layer      | Architect       |
| 06   | <code>/proj-init-aitoolguide</code>  | <code>docs/AI-TOOL-GUIDE.md</code> + adapters        | Architect       |
| 07   | <code>/proj-init-readme</code>       | <code>README.md</code>                               | Architect       |
| 08   | <code>/proj-init-backlog</code>      | <code>docs/BACKLOG.md</code> + host work items       | Product Owner   |
| 09   | <code>/proj-init-finalize</code>     | <code>CONTRIBUTING.md</code> (init-only removed)     | Architect       |
| —    | <code>/proj-init-cleanup</code>      | nothing; unregisters the workspace                   | — (you confirm) |

Solo / process-enforced: one person may wear both hats; take on the one each step calls for. Source of truth: docs/guides/proj-init/(\_steps.yml, \_run-step.md, step guides).